

St Columbkille's Parish Council

Tuesday August 26th 2014

St Columbkille's Church Hall

Opening prayer

Fr Ghislaine opened the meeting with a prayer.

Apologies

Ed McGuigan, Donald Campbell, Evelyn Kearney,
Fr Pat, Irene Lochrin, Bob McNamara, James
Gallagher

Present

Fr Ghislaine, Deacon Bill, Maureen Smith, Tom
Armstrong, Isobel McCormick, Marie Tedeschi,
Michelle McGuire, Francis McKernan, Miriam
McKernan, Irene Galt, Kathy Thomson, Mary
McLaughlin, Mairead Brown, Catherine (reader),
(Elma Harkinson's friend), Helen Deeny

Minutes of meeting

The minutes of the AGM were read out by Miriam
McKernan.

Building report

The following report by Edward McGuigan was submitted, a précis of which was presented at the meeting.

“By way of a update, I have detailed the progress, and plan moving forward, below.

The steering group met just before Fr Pat went on holiday. In conjunction with the project surveyor it was decided that the anticipated start date for phase 2 of the project would be the second week of January 2015. The contractor has advised that they will be able to meet this target and will also be able to provide the same site manager who worked on phase 1.

The programme prior to this is that the architect will finalise their drawings by 31st August. These will go to the surveyor for billing purposes, which will take approximately six weeks. The bill will then go out to the contractor for pricing. It was agreed that there is no advantage in the contractor coming on site before Christmas as we will interrupt the celebrations of the Advent season and little building progress will be gained as a result of the Christmas shutdown within the building sector.

We anticipate meeting the architects next week to review and sanction the final elements of design and finish etc. We are also planning on commencing limited works within the Church during the next few months to get a head start on some of the more time consuming preparation works. These works will not interrupt Worship in any way.

We have arranged to meet with the Bishop and Fabric and Planning Committee at the Diocese in mid-September, at which point we will make the final presentation of our design and cost plans. At that stage we hope to obtain the final go-ahead for phase 2 and confirmation that the Diocese will provide the appropriate level of loan funds.

During July we received confirmation that the Parish has been awarded £244k by Viridor Credits, a sum which provides a huge contribution to the project, and one which would have been completely lost had the project started in May as was originally envisaged. Paul McNeil and Bob MacNamara were entirely responsible for driving this exercise.

Viridor has also advised that they would welcome and further application for phase 3, covering the external landscaping works.

The building programme will run to approximately twenty six weeks, so we should be back in the Church at some time during July 2015.”

Congratulations to Paul McNeill and Bob Mcnamara who were so crucial to the success of the Viridor Grant and also to Elma Harkinson, who, through her son’s contacts, first raised the idea of applying for the grant.

It was also highlighted that the loan from the Bishop will be repayable over 10 years.

We all look forward to work beginning on the second week of January 2015.

Francis McKernan talked through his report on the hall, which is detailed below.

Hall Report 21/08/2014

Ground floor

The door stopper for the door leading from the **Hall** to the West stairway is secured to decorative wooden dado rail on a plasterboard stud wall. As a result the plasterboard is damaged as the wood bows. A rubber stopper bolted to the floor would be a more effective solution.

The plasterboard needs some repair, likely from before the current stopper was installed.

One of the handles for the cupboard door in the **hall kitchen** is loose and rotates.

There is a sign that indicated different coloured knives and chopping boards should be used for different foods, but no sign of the attendant colour coded knives and chopping boards.

West Stair

As a non-residential building, there is not a direct requirement for handrails on both sides of stairways however the Stairway is 1800mm wide between the ground floor and first floor, just shy of the 2000mm

width which would legally require three handrails¹(the stair would be split into two flights) as such, I think it would be sensible to provide a handrail on both sides, this applies to both stairways.

Between the First and Second floor, the stairway is 1400mm wide, therefore there is less need of a second handrail.

There is a loose spindle at the half landing between the First and Second floor. This is the main access to the after-school club. At the moment it is marked with caution tape and does not pose an imminent threat to the children but it is quite unnerving.

East Stair

There is serious discolouration and peeling on the top floor.

When I visited on the 21st of August, both fire escapes, to the north and south were partially obstructed with tables and chairs to the North and portable staging to the South, the obstructions reduced the escape width from 180cm to less than 110. An alternative storage solution must be found for these items.

First Floor

Gambling anonymous room was locked on my visit.

One of the cabinet doors in the **Bar kitchen** is hanging off its hinges. There is also a rust stain on the linoleum from the steel bin.

One of the sliding partitions in the **Margaret McManus Room** seems to be seized up.

The **men's toilets** on this floor are fine, the hinges on the doors could use some grease though!

Second Floor

Some plug sockets in the **after-school care** are damaged or loose, I've attached a diagram (*fig. 1*) indicating the damaged sockets. This seems to be a problem with all the sockets on this floor, but the sockets in the after-school room are in worse condition and obviously should be more of a priority.

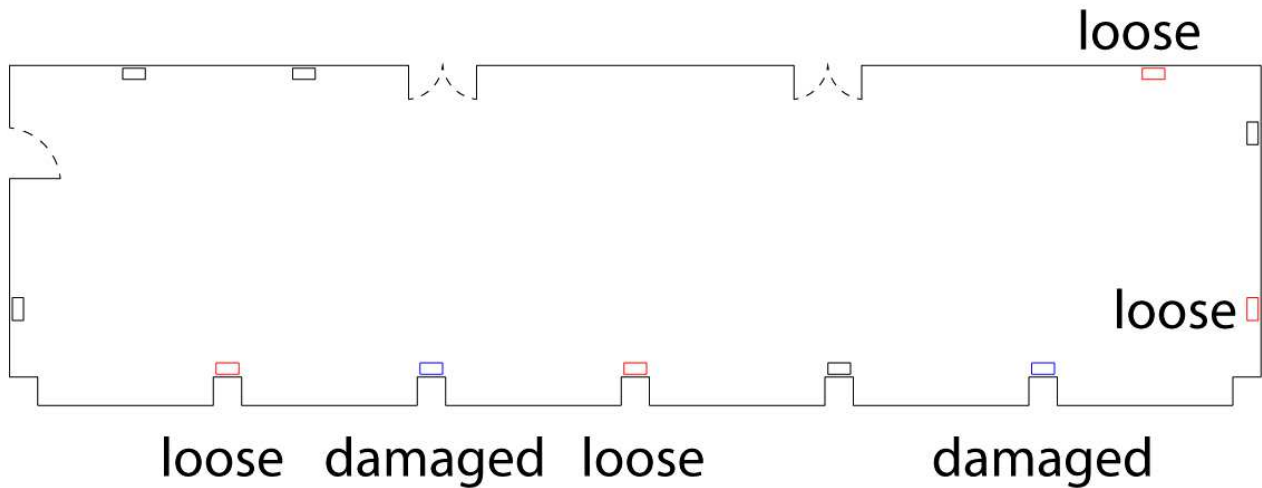


Illustration 1: fig.1

The walls could do with a clean or repaint. This is particularly important for creating a suitable bright environment for children.

Some of the blind cords dangle within the reach of children. This is a safety hazard.

Other than missing a towel dispenser or hand drier, the **men's toilets** are fine. Currently the hand-towels sit on the radiator, a possible fire hazard.

General décor

The flooring and painting throughout the Hall requires to be upgraded.

This report was prepared by Francis McKernan M Arch as instructed by St Columbkille's Parish Council Annual General Meeting August 24 2014.

Many thanks for such a detailed report, Francis.

Colum's concert on 29th March and CD sales raised an excellent sum for the Building Renovation Fund. Congratulations and many thanks to all involved.

The Legion of Mary and their team of volunteers were congratulated on their excellent work during Peregrinatio pro Christi 19-26 July. Marie informed the meeting that one of the very positive results is that 3 new members are joining our Legion of Mary Group in the parish.

Marie and Br. Vincent made door to door visits on all lapsed Catholics and identified the sick & housebound who are seeking communion. This information has been passed to Fr. Hennesy.

RCIA

Maria also has a list of 10 people who have expressed an interest in the RCIA programme and she will pass this information over to Chris Hughes.

Tom Armstrong confirmed that of the 4 people who begin the RCIA programme last year, 3 were welcomed into full membership of the Church at our Easter Vigil this year and that he is aware of possibly 4 new prospective candidates.

Our appreciation was expressed for their prayers, work and devotion in this area.

Cleaners

We were advised that the number of regular cleaners of our Church is in fact 6.

The problem of candle wax was highlighted, particularly during the months of devotion to Our Lady. It would appear candles are left burning around the statue which is a fire hazard. On one occasion, a candle had melted right through the holder and wax had spread over the carpet, marble and into the socket for the microphone.

It was agreed that there should be no candles outwith the designated areas.

Deacon Bill advised that St Andrew's Cathedral, Clyde Street, have candle holders which do not cause molten wax spillage. It was suggested the building & refurbishment group should also consider what type of candle stalls would be most suitable and not damage the newly refurbished church.

Liturgical ministries

Reading –

Fr Ghislaine highlighted the fact that we, as a parish, are very short of readers. There should be 3 readers at every mass – 2 for the reading and 1 for the Prayers of the Faithful.

He said that the liturgical groups within the parish should meet regularly to think and pray together on how best to serve the community as a united group.

Developing on from this, there will be 3 meetings on the first Saturday of October, November and December after 10.00am mass to support the readers of the Liturgy of the Word. Michael McGrath and Helen Deeny will attend.

Evelyn Kearney shared a leaflet for readers which Fr Grant had produced over 20 years ago and it was agreed an updated version would be extremely useful.

It was also suggested that S5 and S6 pupils in our parish would be invited to read. Helen Deeny is to contact Marie Marks to possibly identify any Caritas pupils who would wish to join the Liturgy of the Word.

Deacon Bill said he has a book on the reading of the liturgy which may also be beneficial to the group.

Prayer

Centring Prayer with Br. Vincent. Br Vincent would be happy to give a talk from the pulpit on prayer

within our parish, highlighting all our current prayer groups.

Deacon Bill suggested that the Parish Prayer could be printed in our future new Hymn Books which may be sponsored by individual members of the congregation. This could also include a remembrance for deceased parishioners e.g. Pray for Mr/Mrs XXXX.

Passkeepers

The role and importance of the passkeepers was highlighted by Fr Ghislaine. He felt there should be a group that meets to discuss the opening and closing of the church. Such an important role should be shared amongst all passkeepers so the Church does not need to rely on only one or two passkeepers to open and close the church.

Informing the Parish

Deacon Bill, Evelyn Kearney and Miriam McKernan carried out a survey of the porch area and it has been decided that the two green baize boards on the left and right as you enter the church will be used; one to display information of the times of Sunday masses, Sacraments etc and the other detailing all the different groups within the parish, when and where they meet.

A banner is being made up for the front gates to advertise Sunday masses as all other churches in

Rutherglen announce their services outside the building. A PDF is attached showing how the banner would look and they will be displayed on the side gates at the front of the Church.

Church Car Park:

It was suggested that a banner be made for the car park and agreed a new notice stating "The car park is for the use of patrons of the church" should be displayed.

Church Stall

Mairead Brown said the Stall was well serviced at Sunday masses and 10.00am daily mass but that more helpers would be welcome for 1.00pm daily mass.

Catherine Edvaldsson told the meeting that there are still 300 surplus Christmas Cards which were being sold to raise funds. Fr Pat asked Catherine to find out the cost of producing A6 size cards - £165 for 500. It was suggested that Ed contact the card designer, Alison Brown, to determine the financial viability of ordering more. The latest date for production is 7th October.

Scout Group

More members urgently sought.

Rutherglen Foodbank are now using the top floor of the hall and Tom Armstrong advised the meeting that 945 people are being fed by the Bank.

The meeting closed with a prayer.

Date of the next parish council meeting: Tuesday 7th October 2014